

WordPress Comments

Enabling, editing, and moderating comments on your WordPress site

Table of Contents

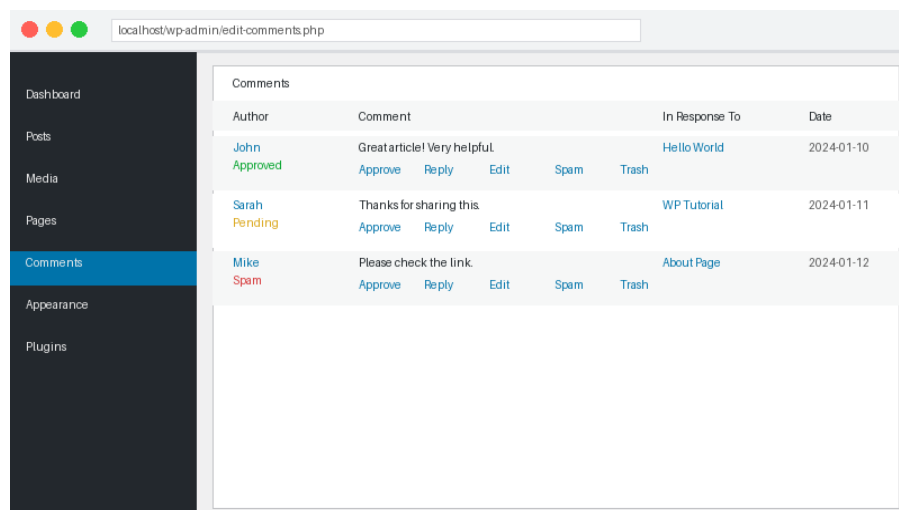
1. What Are Comments in WordPress?
2. Enabling and Disabling Comments
3. Editing Comments in WordPress
4. Moderation of Comments in WordPress

Since WordPress allows creators to interact with readers easily, there needs to be a way to receive feedback and reviews. Comments on WordPress make this two-way communication possible, helping you understand what your audience wants and how to serve them better.

1. What Are Comments in WordPress?

Comments are a unique feature that allows WordPress users to interact with bloggers and their team. The primary intention of using Comments is to understand what your readers and viewers are looking for, and to receive direct feedback about your content.

By default, the comment box is enabled on all new posts and pages. Comments can be activated or deactivated on a per-page or global basis. There is also an option for trackbacks and pingbacks to monitor external references.



WordPress Admin — Comments management screen showing Author, Comment, Status, and Actions

2. Enabling and Disabling Comments

There are two methods to control comment availability in WordPress:

Method 1 — Per Page / Post

Use this method to enable or disable comments on individual pages:

- 1 Log in** — Sign in to your WordPress admin dashboard.
- 2 All Pages** — Navigate to Pages > All Pages.
- 3 Open a Page** — Choose any page from the list and click to open it.
- 4 Screen Options** — Click the Screen Options drop-down in the top-right corner.
- 5 Enable Discussion** — Tick the checkbox for Discussion and Comments.
- 6 Comment Box Visible** — The discussion and comment box will now appear at the bottom of the page.

Method 2 — Global Settings

Use this method to enable or disable comments site-wide:

- 1 Dashboard** — Go to your WordPress Admin Dashboard.
- 2 Settings** — Navigate to Settings in the Admin Sidebar.
- 3 Discussion** — Choose Discussion from the Settings submenu.
- 4 Toggle Comments** — Check or uncheck "Allow people to post comments on new articles".

Un-ticking either checkbox will automatically disable the comment option.

"Allow trackbacks and pingbacks" lets viewers ping and trackback their actions on your site. Global settings apply to all new content — existing pages retain their individual settings.

3. Editing Comments in WordPress

Editing comments is possible only from the administrator's account. Follow these steps:

- 1 Comments Menu** — From the WordPress Dashboard, navigate to the Comments menu.
- 2 View All Comments** — You will see a list of all comments from every page on your site.
- 3 Select a Comment** — Click on the comment you wish to edit — the Edit link will appear.
- 4 Edit Comment Page** — Clicking Edit opens the full Edit Comment screen.
- 5 Update** — Make your changes and click the Update button to save them.

Editable Field	Description
Name	The commenter's display name shown alongside the comment.
Email Address	The commenter's email — not publicly visible but used for notifications.
URL	The commenter's website URL, which appears as a link on their name.
Comment	The full body text of the comment itself.

Only administrators can edit comments — authors and editors cannot.
Editing a comment does not notify the original commenter.
All edits are logged internally in WordPress for accountability.

4. Moderation of Comments in WordPress

Comment Moderation is a technique where comments submitted by readers are held for admin review before being published publicly. It is the primary defence against comment spam.

Moderation ensures that no spam or inappropriate content appears on your site automatically. Held comments are visible only to administrators until approved. You can approve, decline, mark as spam, or permanently trash any pending comment.

Moderation Actions Available

When reviewing a comment in the Comments menu, administrators can take the following actions:

Action	Effect
Approve	Makes the comment publicly visible on the post or page.
Unapprove	Hides a previously approved comment from public view.
Reply	Allows the admin to directly reply to the comment from the moderation screen.
Edit	Opens the full comment editor to modify the comment content.
Spam	Marks the comment as spam and removes it from public view.
Trash	Moves the comment to Trash — can be restored or permanently deleted.

Trashed comments can be restored within 30 days before being permanently deleted. Spam comments help train WordPress's spam filter for future submissions. You can enable email notifications to be alerted whenever a new comment awaits approval.